

THE

INTERNATIONAL CHRISTIAN FELLOWSHIP

Worker's Manual

GUIDELINES FOR CONDUCT AND PRACTICE

FOR WORKERS IN THE ICF MINISTRY AND MOVEMENT

GUIDELINES

For Workers in the ICF Ministry and Movement

The Lord appointed this Ministry and Movement to be one of His Divine instruments to prepare the saints for the second coming of the Lord Jesus Christ — transforming lives, equipping believers, and making disciples for the work of ministry.

This handbook sets out the guidelines, duties, code of conduct, and standards of discipline that govern every worker in the ICF Ministry and Movement. Please read it prayerfully and in full before signing the Worker's Covenant.

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PART ONE

Foundations of Service

"There is a unique prophetic anointing to accomplish God's vision and mission for this Ministry."

GUIDELINES — SECTION A

Foundations Character Discipline & Growth

A

GUIDELINES

General

The Lord appointed this Ministry and Movement to be one of His Divine instruments to prepare the saints for the second coming of the Lord Jesus Christ by:

- transforming people's life from positions of instability and stagnancy into positions of confidence and sustained growth;
- to give believers practical tools and principles for victorious living; and
- to make disciples and equip them for the work of ministry

There is a unique prophetic anointing to accomplish God's vision and mission for this Ministry and every worker must seek to be equipped and used by God to fulfil His purposes through him or her.

B

GUIDELINES

Defining a Worker

In this Ministry and Movement of ICF, a worker is one who has been set aside for special services in the house of God or ministry on the recommendation of the local or regional minister or coordinator in charge of the congregation or ministry.

GUIDELINES — B

Defining a Worker, Continued

These may include members of the Worship team or Choir, Ushers, Discipleship teachers, Children's workers, and other ministry roles.

It is to be made clear that those who are privileged to be workers in this Ministry and Movement primarily work for God and therefore will receive their reward, as the Scriptures point out from the Almighty God. But are working for God through ICF as a body appointed by God. Their loyalty to God and to ICF must therefore be unwavering.

C

GUIDELINES

Duties of a Worker

IN ADDITION to the area of ministry they have been appointed to or called upon to serve in (guidance booklets for particular ministries can be obtained from departmental leaders or local minster/coordinator), Workers' duties include the following:

1. Prayer and Intercession

Prayer is of paramount importance in achieving results in the work of Ministry and in any other endeavours. Workers in ministry have a duty to pray without ceasing (1 Thessalonians 5:17) for the Ministry and Movement, its programmes and projects, for members and fellow workers, for themselves and for the power of God to be great in the Ministry.

It is advised, among other things that workers should pray fervently:

GUIDELINES — C

Workers Should Pray Fervently

- for the vision, mission and progress of this Ministry and Movement
- for the ICF Ministers, Assistant Ministers and their families
- for the spiritual, numerical and financial progress of the Church and Ministry
- for the expansion of the Ministry and Movement as a whole and for the expansion of the Church to which the worker belong.
- for the sick, the jobless and those with material needs for healing, provision of gainful work and for the needs to be met.
- for the ICF ministry and missions both locally and internationally
- for the ICF Ministry and Movement Leader, National Coordinator, Regional Coordinators, Local Coordinators, Other Leaders and Workers at every level.
- for the work of reconciliation and restoration of backsliders into the family of the church and into a healthy and robust relationship with God
- for himself or herself as a worker and for fellow workers for spiritual progress and in all areas of their life.
- for all members of this Ministry and Movement; for God's provision of material and financial prosperity, good health and spiritual prosperity and also for their children for divine protection, knowledge, wisdom, good health and progress.

LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLE

A worker who prays without ceasing for the Ministry, its leaders, and its people carries the Movement forward in the Spirit — prayer is not a duty added to the work; it is the work beneath the work.

GUIDELINES — C

Mission, Discipleship & Financial Life

2. Mission and Discipleship

Every worker is expected to:

- be an active soul winner and addicted to witnessing for Christ
- be engaged in sharing their faith and the gospel by all means possible including word of mouth, distribution of gospel tracts and fliers, Youth events, internet, evangelistic meetings, phone and friendship evangelism etc
- invite people to the church to hear the word and experience God's presence.
- engage in disciple making or discipleship and most actively be involved in follow up and discipleship programmes

3. Financial Life of the Ministry

Workers are to:

- make financial contributions to the programmes and projects of their local ICF church and the Ministry and Movement as a whole
- generously support the Ministers and their families
- assist those who are needy in the church and ministry



PART TWO

Calling & Character

"Every successful organisation requires some basic qualifications for one to work with them."

GUIDELINES — SECTIONS D & E

Foundations · Character · Discipline & Growth

D

GUIDELINES

Who Qualifies to Be a Worker?

Every successful organisation requires some basic qualifications for one to work with them. In this Ministry and Movement, to qualify as a worker a person ought to be:

1. Born again believer
   John 3:3 and John 3:5
2. Filled with the Holy Spirit
   Acts 1:8
3. Baptised in Water
   Matthew 28:19; Acts 16:15–16
4. A Regular Tithe payer
   Malachi 3:10
5. A cheerful giver
   1 Corinthians 9:7
6. An active Soul Winner
   Mark 16:15–16
7. A humble person
   Isaiah 57:15, Luke 22:26
8. An avid Intercessor and Prayerful Person
   1 Thessalonians 5:17; James 5:13–18
9. Of good character and conduct
   Hebrews 13:5; Acts 6:3; Philippians 1:27
10. A Trustworthy person
    Jeremiah 35:1–8
11. A person who is spiritually growing, is faithful, available, and teachable
12. Other qualifications which the Ministry may consider necessary

E

GUIDELINES

Code of Conduct

Every successful organisation and profession has a Code of Practice, Code of Conduct, Code of Ethics to enable them to work efficiently, competently and safely, maximising their professionalism and output and minimising their mistakes and negative results.

> *As pointed out in John 20:21, we are Ambassadors of Christ representing Christ and our church wherever we are and protecting the name of Christ and of our Ministry or Movement with our good conduct and character and against negative accusations from others. We are the Salt of the earth and the light of the world.*
>
> JOHN 20:21; MATTHEW 5:13–16

The workers are very important to God and to the Ministry. In order to be efficient and effective and for the smooth operation of the organisation, workers should observe the following code of conduct:

The Worker Must:

- be totally submissive to constituted authorities of the Ministry or Movement (*1 Peter* 5:5; *1 Corinthians* 16:16; *Hebrews* 13:17)
- be courteous to inform the leaders when they would not be available or are travelling
- be ready and willing to undertake all assignments given or go wherever asked to go. Where the worker is unable to do or go then the worker should politely request to be excused with good cause (*Joshua* 1:16)
- be an example to the congregation in submitting to the doctrine of the Church (*Titus* 2:7; *1 Timothy* 4:6; *Titus* 1:9)
- be an example to the congregation in giving your resources and time and spending for God (*2 Corinthians* 12:15, *Galatians* 2:20)

GUIDELINES — E

Code of Conduct, Continued

- avoid creating dissention and criticising the leaders with other workers in the absence of the leaders or behind their back — this can develop into an act of betrayal and affect the growth of the ministry.

> ! *Complaints should be channelled only to the appropriate place.* (*Numbers* 14:35–37; *Mark* 14:10; *Titus* 1:10–13 *etc.*)

- be respectful in dealing with things he disagrees with. If the leaders give orders which contradict the Bible or is ungodly, the worker is not obliged to carry this out and should indeed point this out but with respect and in a Godly manner. (*1 Peter* 5:1–7)
- maintain high standard of hygiene, personal and otherwise (*Isaiah* 52:11)
- dress smartly and decently as is approved by the word of God (*1 Peter* 3:4; *1 Timothy* 2:9; *Isaiah* 3:16–26)
- be a person who is a worthy ambassador of Christ and His Church, who when he moves to another town, city or place where no branch of this ministry is, will be prepared to start one there or ask for help to start one under the supervision and guidance of the regional or national leadership. (*Acts* 8:4; *Acts* 11:19)
- be a person who is happy to attend prayers and meetings and where possible or space and schedule permits, is happy to have a prayer group in his or her home (*Acts* 16:25, *Luke* 6:12)
- be punctual at meetings and early when on duty (*Hebrews* 10:25)
- always ready to protect the good name of the church, ministry and movement
- walking in the Spirit, worshiping in the Spirit and growing in the Spirit (*Galatians* 5:16; *John* 4:23–24; *Psalms* 17:12; *Colossians* 3)



PART THREE

Discipline, Growth & Christlike Service

"For whom the LORD loves He chastens, and scourges every son whom He receives."

HEBREWS 12:6

Foundations Character Discipline & Growth

F

GUIDELINES

Discipline

It must be noted that discipline in the church is biblical and is by no means intended to harm but to correct and bring out the good in a person. Discipline is necessary to protect and to prune the body of Christ for growth and future success. Discipline is good for you.

> *For whom the LORD loves He chastens, and scourges every son whom He receives.*
>
> HEBREWS 12:6

> *As many as I love, I rebuke and chasten. Therefore be zealous and repent.*
>
> REVELATION 3:19

Discipline in the house of God must be done firmly but in love and the person who accepts and undergoes discipline successfully must be appreciated and received back with warmth and love.

If any worker sins, or does something which is considered wrong and destructive or likely to be destructive to the progress or good image of this Ministry or Movement or the local church, the worker will receive adequate disciplinary or punitive measure in proportion to the offence.

GUIDELINES — F

Discipline, Continued

The measure can range from private or open rebuke depending on the delicacy of the matter; suspension from the workers meetings for a period of time or where deemed fit after consultation with the leadership team, a dismissal.

Where a worker immediately realises their mistake or error and asks for forgiveness, the matter, depending on its gravity, may be dealt with quickly and the worker allowed to continue in the service of the Lord and His Ministry.

A worker who is under suspension is only suspended from duties but ought to continue attending church services regularly and participate as a valued member of the congregation like other members.

A worker who is not satisfied with the discipline or feels that the discipline is not warranted can appeal to the local minister or where not satisfied to the Regional Coordinator or where necessary, to the National Coordinator. It is expected that these leaders will give a loving and fair hearing and judgement to the worker, in consultation with the leader who meted the discipline and guided by the Scriptures and growth of the ministry and Movement.

RESTORATION FIRST

A worker who is found to be wrong but shows genuine repentance may be pardoned and allowed back into the service of the Lord at any stage, even before the expiry of the suspension period.

G

GUIDELINES

Elevation of Workers in Ministry

Where there is no genuine repentance or acceptance of mistake even after suspension, the worker may be recommended for dismissal from the role of a worker.

Depending on the nature of the case and the level of the worker, discipline, suspension or dismissal may be undertaken at the local, regional, national or the Overseer level.

Any promotion of workers to higher leadership roles or allocation of duties will be done in accordance with the Scriptures and taking into account their character, skills and ability, availability and their ability to work in a team and with those who are in leadership over them.

Workers who exhibit exceptional character and commitment, have shown willingness to learn and have indeed done so to reasonable levels and have exhibited spiritual endowments and spiritual and soul winning abilities may in due course after undertaking recommended in-house or other training, be promoted.

! *The promotion may, depending on the calling, be to the level of Assistant Minister or Pastor or whatever role will be deemed necessary but in accordance with the Ministry and Movement Structure.*

H

GUIDELINES

Jesus and the Workers

Workers in this Ministry and Movement are appointed by God through the ministers and coordinators to partake of the divine purpose of God in harvesting; making disciples, church growth and upholding the ministry.

In His ministry, Jesus Christ, our Lord and Master, taught us about training, obedience, commitment and being responsible as workers.

Jesus had many who attended his meetings. Sometimes he taught only a handful but at another time we see him feeding five thousand at one point.

We are also told that he had appointed the seventy or seventy two workers who he trained and sent out to do the work *(Luke* 10).

He also had a selected few, the twelve, later called the apostles with whom he spent quality time and gave important tasks in his ministry. He appeared to have imparted upon them special anointing.

Then there is Peter, John and James, the three who are mentioned many times as being with Him. It is these three with whom he was at the transfiguration. *(See also 1 Corinthians* 15:5–8)

While we are all equal before God and every person deserves respect and fair treatment, we must recognise that the Bible recognises due respect to leadership and authority, both spiritual and temporal.

GUIDELINES — H

Jesus and the Workers, Continued

Workers in this Ministry have to see themselves as part of the seventy, appointed by Jesus for special service. They are set aside for great service and advised to be selfless and not greedy or selfish. They are told to prepare to absorb hardship and difficulties in the process of ministry. They sent as lambs among wolves. (*Luke* 10:1–17)

Jesus sent the seventy in pairs into towns giving them special mandate and instructions. Workers have to take instructions and be obedient. If you have a problem with being obedient or obeying your pastor or leaders, it may be that you are not yet fit to serve under them and therefore your becoming a worker there may impede the work of God. The victorious army of Gideon became selected by their level of discipline and fitness.

Do you need to be followed up by your leaders every time in order to do the right thing or work properly? Or are you a worthy and faithful servant who serves the Lord even when no one is pushing you or supervising you or even praising you? (*Matthew* 6:1–3)

> *Therefore, my beloved, as you have always obeyed, not as in my presence only, but now much more in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling.*
>
> PHILIPPIANS 2:12

In this Ministry, workers perform their duties as faithful and trusted men and women of God with less or no supervision. We develop a culture of responsibility, not playing the blame game which Adam and Eve resorted to. We give the work our best shot at all times.

SERVING WHOLEHEARTEDLY

Working as unto the Lord

Bondservants, obey in all things your masters according to the flesh, not with eyeservice, as men-pleasers, but in sincerity of heart, fearing God. And whatever you do, do it heartily, as to the Lord and not to men, knowing that from the Lord you will receive the reward of the inheritance; for you serve the Lord Christ. But he who does wrong will be paid for what he has done, and there is no partiality.

COLOSSIANS 3:22–25

Pray for the Workers

The Ministers, Pastors, Regional and National Leaders have the responsibility to pray for all the workers in this Ministry and Movement and their families without ceasing.

As the Bible says that the worker shall obtain their reward from the Father, we pray that each worker in this Ministry shall obtain their well deserved reward and Favour both here on earth and before the Father at the end.

IN CLOSING

Worker's Commitment

If you have read this document and are willing to prayerfully abide by all that is in it then you have what it takes. You may sign the Worker's Covenant form and give it to your Pastor or Coordinator and you will be informed when you can begin your service.

May God Bless You Abundantly

"For I know the plans I have for you, plans for good and not for evil, to give you a good future and a hope."

JEREMIAH 29:11

INTERNATIONAL CHRISTIAN FELLOWSHIP

Pleasing God Is All About Jesus

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